adaptability of the Christian ideological yearning towards spiritual and psychological enslavement of the ‘Other’, manifested in the post-Enlightenment world as ‘secularism’. Christian theology also proved an irresistible handmaiden to the prolonged plunder of colonised lands and it inflicted a particularly devastating tragedy by severing indigenous traditions from the seamless continuity of life with nature that many non-European societies practised. Of course, brutal violence, cynical contrivance and the manipulation of local divisions and fissures were the important immediate and daily adjuncts to the colonial rule.

Sai Deepak focuses detailed attention on an issue of particular importance to Bharatiyas, which is the likely nature of the colonial impact on their civilisation, and the relevance of coloniality to explain their current predicament. In a thoroughly fleshed out exegesis, Sai Deepak reiterates the findings of leading scholars of Bharat on how deeply coloniality has imbued Indic consciousness, which exhibits itself in self-abnegation, even self-loathing. Every aspect of Bharatiya society, including its governance and legal structures, originates in colonial constructs that disavow Bharat’s indigeneity. Its continuing adroitness in nurturing extra-national loyalties and tethering Bharat’s intellectual life to the interests of extra-civilisational detractors can only be described as dismaying.

Poignantly, the European worldview continues to prevail in former colonies, such as Bharat, without the need to actually espouse Christianity, since it spawned the secular worldview and framework from within its established traditions and scriptural injunctions. This misconceived explanatory framework, which continues to hold sway in Bharat, fails to grasp the nature of the continuing adversarial demonisation of Bharat’s indigeneity by mis-specifying the very parameters of the discourse and misdirecting it towards overarching intellectual sources of stupefaction, such as secularism. Sai Deepak also highlights the role of coloniality in Bharat’s failure to truly excavate the nature of the Islamic impact on Indic culture, which is itself a product of secular political expediency that enjoins deceit and self-delusion in the alleged interest of buying that elusive social peace. In the same vein, Marxism is also rightly deemed as just another universalising European project, though in Bharat it has been repackaged to accommodate crass contemporary exigencies and has long allied itself opportunistically with both European and Middle Eastern imperialisms.